

## Segment 27 McCormick Wilderness

(Formerly Segment 24), Updated April 2026 [Google Map of Segment 27](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

**Trail Adopter:** We have split the wilderness in 2 parts for trail maintenance, with the dividing line being the highest point in Marquette County as designated on Avenza.  
Eastern portion Karen Pruess [karen.pruess@gmail.com](mailto:karen.pruess@gmail.com), Jeff Solka [jeffreypsolka@charter.net](mailto:jeffreypsolka@charter.net)  
Western portion: Jo Thurber & Tom Strietzel, [joeandtom555@gmail.com](mailto:joeandtom555@gmail.com)

**Segment length:** About 6.8 miles, east to west 426 ft of ascent, 276 ft of descent

**Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#)** Use Maps # 35 & 36 in Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact [mac@northcountrytrail.org](mailto:mac@northcountrytrail.org) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

***Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.***

**On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)**

The McCormick Wilderness is federal land managed by the Ottawa National Forest so blazes and other markings are not allowed. The tread is not always obvious so **it's easy to miss a turn and get off trail and lost. Using Avenza maps on a phone or gps is highly recommended.**

From the parking area at (46.653563,-87.957707) a short hike into the woods brings you to a kiosk where you can register prior to entering the wilderness. This area has some of the most incredible virgin timber in the state. The oldest white pine in the state was found and confirmed in 2021. The trail crosses a few creeks that can be rock hopped. There are also a couple beaver dam "walls" that have created a nice lake- a wonderful place to have lunch or take a nap. The highest point in Marquette County is located at (46.650627,-88.013317). About 6 ½ miles after entering the wilderness, you come to an intersecting trail. Turn left and cross the bridge over the Peshekee River. A kiosk is located just after the bridge at the end of this segment. (46.642158,-88.046544) The parking area is a short walk past the kiosk.

### Driving Directions

#### Eastern Trailhead:

From the traffic circle by the Meijer Gas Station in Marquette, take US-41 west for 28 miles through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [*County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./ Huron Bay Grade*] for 4.1 miles. Turn right and follow Dishno Rd. for approximately 1.6 miles. Stay left onto an unnamed gravel road (turning off of Dishno Rd, which turns right at this point). Follow this road (which may be labeled Wildcat Creek Rd on some maps) for about 6 miles. This may be labeled Carlson's Corner, and there is a large rock in the middle of the intersection. Turn left. Go to the fork at 0.7 mile and stay left. You will come to a red gate that is closed but unlocked. You may go through but be sure to close the gate each time you go through it to respect the property owners who have so kindly given us permission to pass through. Go about a mile from the fork and park. For those who prefer to follow Google Map, here is the [Driving Map from US 41 to parking for East McCormick](#)

#### Western Trailhead:

From Marquette, take US-41 west through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [*County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./ Huron Bay Grade*]. This road is blacktopped but is very rough in spots, so drive slowly. Stay on [*County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./ Huron Bay Grade*] for a little over 9 miles. (Be careful not to take Dishno Road to the right at about 4.1 miles.) There will be a parking area for McCormick Wilderness located on the right. A primitive restroom is located near the parking area. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving map from US41 to McCormick parking](#). This map has not been verified yet but should be accurate.

### Camping:

The McCormick Wilderness is a federal wilderness so dispersed camping is allowed.

### Water Access:

Water is available at the Peshekee River and numerous water crossings.

### Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach the eastern trailhead. The eastern trailhead is not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.

The western trailhead can be reached year-round, although an AWD vehicle is recommended in winter.